

From Household Enterprise to Business Confidence: A Journey of Learning and Growth

Challenges are a part of life and they come to build a new version of us which is better and stronger from the earlier one. All we need to do at that time is to not give up and continue with our efforts and dedication. This is the case of Bimla Ji from Shimla, Himachal Pradesh who started her business to be able to support her family and fulfill the financial needs for maintaining a stable livelihood. She started the business of producing and selling ghee with the financial assistance taken from the savings offered via SHG in the year around 2020. In the regions surrounding mountains, ghee is an important and commonly sold product.

The financial and Digital literacy training was very much useful for her in many aspects of the business. One of them is regarding the calculation of actual cost of production. Earlier she was not adding the cost of her own hard work and her own time but after attending the training she realised that the cost of production must include all the relevant costs to get an accurate price of the product. Another aspect that she learnt about was the cost effectiveness, she learnt about what quantity must be offered at what price so as to be able to benefit both the customer and the seller. This understanding made her calculate business costs and profits accurately.



Moving ahead, earlier she was having the understanding of cashbook and balancesheet, and she was also not maintaining systematic financial records but after the training she realised the importance of preparing clear and detailed records of the business so as to be able to track business activities and improve the areas wherever it is required. She also understood the significance of taking the business online beyond the local area and reaching a wider customer base. For this she even applied for the GST registration and understood all the registration compliances associated with it. The training made her understand how the mechanism of formal registration processes takes place including what are its dos and don'ts.

She has also diversified her business by moving into the category of pickles as well creating another source of income for her. She also learnt about packaging, labelling and marketing during the training and understood it well but now when she has implemented what she learnt, she aspires to learn more through advance training on business practices.

After returning to the village from the training, Bimla Ji shared the knowledge with other women to make sure that they also take the benefit of it. Today, Bimla Ji represents that women can become a great entrepreneur when she is provided with the opportunities to learn and grow.